

8.2 South Korean Man Dies Gaming

From <http://snipurl.com/digitgame2>

On 10 August 2005, it was reported that a South Korean man had died after playing an online computer game for 50 hours with few breaks. The 28-year-old collapsed after playing the game *Starcraft* at an Internet cafe in the city of Taegu, according to South Korean authorities. The man had not slept properly, and had eaten very little during his marathon session, said police.

Multi-player gaming in South Korea is extremely popular thanks to its fast and widespread broadband network. Games are televised and professional players are treated, as well as paid, like sports stars. Professional gamers there attract huge sums in sponsorship and can make more than \$100,000 a year.

The man, identified by his family name, Lee, started playing *Starcraft* on 3 August. He only paused playing to go to the toilet and for short periods of sleep, said the police. "We presume the cause of death was heart failure stemming from exhaustion," a Taegu provincial police official told the Reuters news agency.

